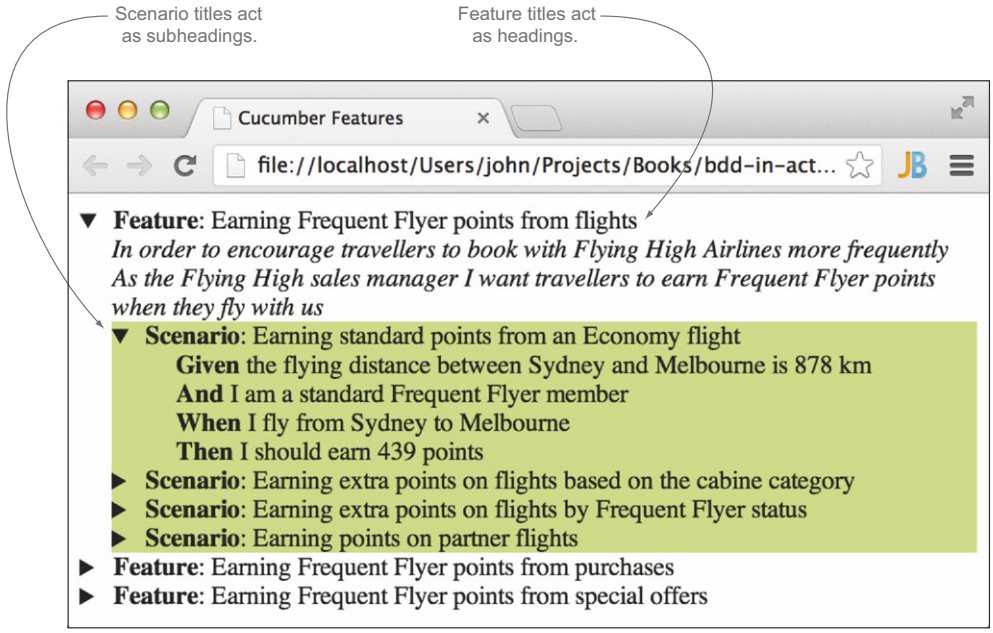


Figure 5.4 A very basic Cucumber report, showing how scenario titles act as subheadings in the living documentation reports

Because scenarios are based on real business examples, the context and events are usually relatively stable, but the expected outcomes may change as the organization changes and evolves the way it does business.

Gherkin also lets you complement the scenario title with a description,[4] as shown in this example:

```
Scenario: Earning standard points from an Economy flight
Normal flights earn 1 point every 2 kilometers
Given the flying distance between Sydney and Melbourne is 878 km
And I am a standard Frequent Flyer member
When I fly from Sydney to Melbourne
Then I should earn 439 points
```

Anything after the scenario title and before the first Given is considered to be a description.

This is a great way to add extra details about business rules or calculations, as the additional text will appear as part of the living documentation.

5.2.3 The "Given ... When ... Then" structure

The meat of each scenario is made up of three parts: an initial state or context, an action or event, and an expected result. As you saw in chapters 1 and 2, these are expressed using the following structure:

[4] Thucydides also honors this convention in JBehave tests.